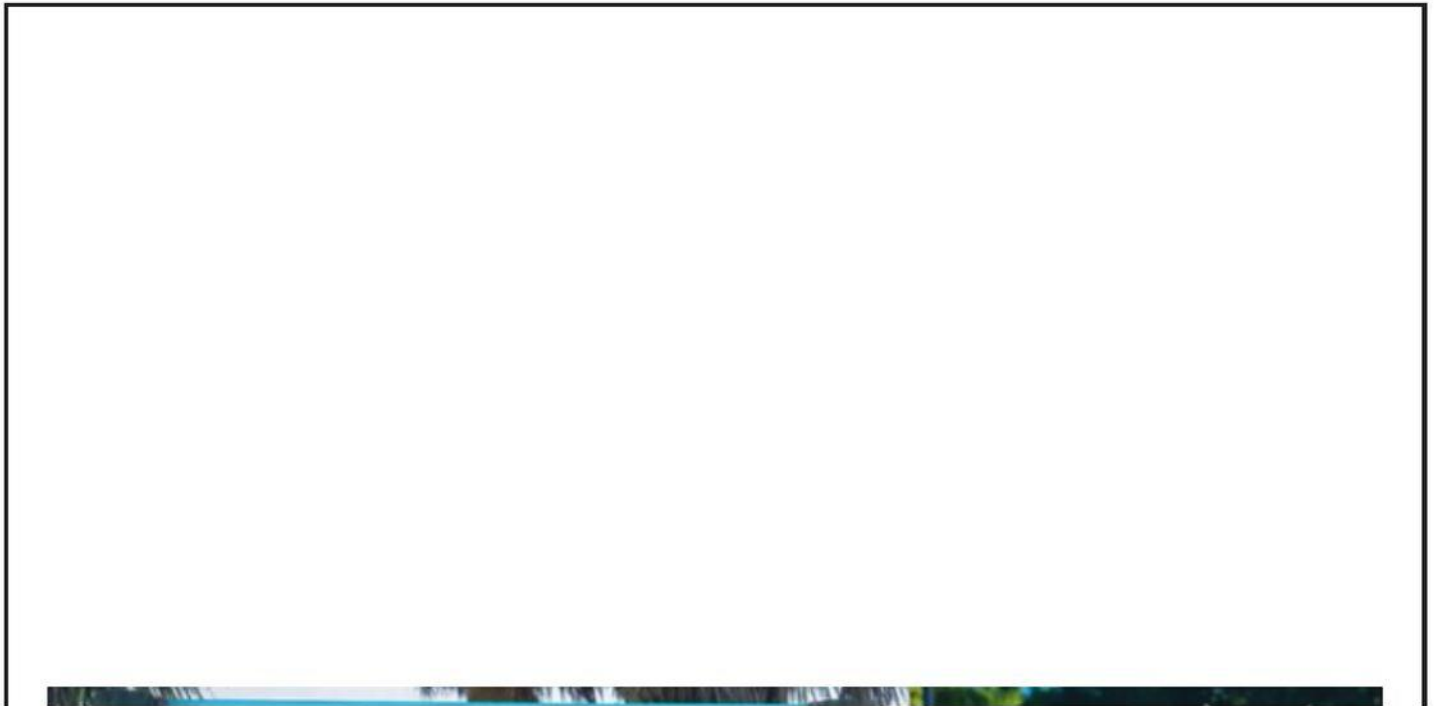




June 2026





GERALDSON COMMUNITY GARDEN GRAND OPENING TOMORROW!

10am-Noon

Sat. May 30th, 2026

1401 99th St NW Bradenton
(Next to Palma Sola Botanical Park)

Join us as Manatee County Commissioners Tal Siddique and Amanda Ballard cut the ribbon tomorrow on this exciting new space dedicated to growing produce, fostering community connections, and providing hands-on learning opportunities for all. This event will include a community garden tour, opportunity to meet our Community Garden Program Specialists, see the newly painted mural, as well as seed giveaways and children's crafts from Palma Sola Botanical Park and Hope Seeds. This free, family-friendly event is open to the public. No RSVP needed.

Palma Sola Botanical Park has 2 plots they will be using to educate the Bright Futures high school volunteers weekly on the basics of gardening. We will keep you posted!



iNATURALIST & AI

Something cutting edge is happening at Palma Sola Botanical Park — and you're invited!

We've launched a citizen science project using iNaturalist, a free app created by a non-profit organization that utilizes a social network of everyday citizen scientists, biologists, botanists, and more to map and share observations of plants and animals into a global

database. Our Bright Futures high school volunteers are already out in the park photographing plants — leaves, flowers, fruits, whatever is showing that week — and

photographing plants — leaves, flowers, fruits, whatever is showing that week — and building a living record of the park's collection over time. That data will feed directly into new upcoming guided tours that will be created using artificial intelligence (AI).

Here's where you come in... open iNaturalist (download the app below), point your phone, and help us collect data. The most helpful aspect is to upload the photo and location. You don't need to worry about duplicates or incorrectly identified species, as the collective group will make corrections, if need be. Most importantly, get out into nature and have fun!

Apple Phones:
[iNaturalist App - App Store](#)

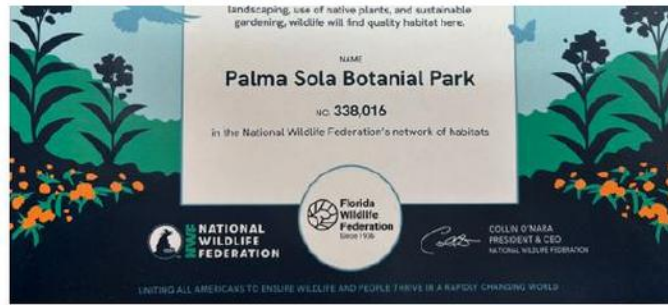
Android Phones:
[iNaturalist - Apps on Google Play](#)



CERTIFIED WILDLIFE HABITAT

The National Wildlife Federation has certified Palma Sola Botanical Park as a Certified Wildlife Habitat due our abundant variety of wildlife! Help us track them with iNaturalist.





GRANTS RECEIVED!

We are excited to announce that Palma Sola Botanical Park recently received four more grants! We are so appreciative of these amazing local organizations that support our mission to provide an interactive learning environment that fosters an appreciation of nature, preserves our natural resources, and promotes environmental education. We sincerely thank you!



Sarasota Bay Estuary Program

native littoral pond plants & educational interpretive signage



Service Club

OF MANATEE COUNTY
CHANGING CHILDREN'S LIVES SINCE 1927

Service Club of Manatee County
supplies for school field trips



Florida Native Plant Society - Serenoa Chapter
new native trees



Manatee River Garden Club
3 large stumps removed from Hurricane Milton





2026 Summer Fun Nature Classes

Come beat the heat this summer with indoor classes in the A/C! All ages are welcome; however, children must be accompanied by an adult. All classes are free unless otherwise noted. Some classes are limited in size, so call to reserve!

June 10, 2026 **Wed. 2-3pm** **BEEKEEPING** by Master Beekeeper Kevin Lausman
Learn about the art of beekeeping & honey, then as an option, follow Kevin to beehives on our grounds.

June 17, 2026 **Wed. 1-2pm** **iNATURALIST** by PSBP Volunteer of the Year Randy C.
Bring your cell phone to learn how to identify plants & wildlife plus more on the amazing iNaturalist app.

June 23, 2026 **Tues. 10-11:30am** **ROCK PAINTING** by Kathy Hoersting w/ Bradenton Rocks!
Come paint rocks to hide in the gardens and around town, then follow their journey on Facebook. \$3/rock

July 9, 2026 **Thurs. 9-10am** **BIRDING** by Christie Leamon w/ Man. Co. Audubon Society
Learn the basics and more of birding, then as an option, follow Christie in search of birds in our gardens.

July 17, 2026 **Fri. 1-2 pm** **BOTANICAL JOURNALING** by Artist Cynthia Maniglia
Learn how to press & journal plants, then take home your own journal to continue at home. \$5/book

July 22, 2026 **Wed. 1-2pm** **PLANT BINGO** by Palma Sola Botanical Park Staff
Join Executive Director Bev & Office Manager Jenny for botanical themed bingo to win plants! \$5

July 23, 2026 **Thurs. 2-3pm** **RESCUE ANIMALS** by Krista Carpenter w/ Wildlife, Inc.
Wildlife rescuer will bring several rehabilitated birds, tortoises, & more to learn about and meet up close.

July 30, 2026 **Thurs. 10-11am** **STORYTIME** by Meaghan Darling w/ Manatee Library
Pre-school to elementary school age children are invited to hear nature books read aloud & enjoy crafts.

August 6, 2026 **Thurs. 10:30am-1pm** **BONSAI** by Kathrin Harris w/ Sho Fu Bonsai Society
Come learn about the ancient art of bonsai, then make and take home your very own bonsai. \$50/tree

August 13, 2026 **Thurs. 11am-12pm** **TREE BIOLOGY** by Richard Larsen w/ FL Division of Forestry
Learn about tree anatomy & their many benefits, then as an option, follow Richard to discuss trees on site.



9800 17th Avenue Northwest Bradenton, Florida 34209

palmasolabp.org

941-761-2866

ADENTON,



BRADENTON'S BEST

Voting has ended, but we just wanted to thank so many of you that so loyally voted for us daily. The results will be revealed on August 2nd. We will publish the results in our August newsletter, so keep your fingers crossed!



2026 HORTICULTURAL CLASSES

The University of Florida/IFAS Manatee County Extension have partnered with us to offer classes at the Palma Sola Botanical Park. Join us to hear Horticultural Agent & Florida-Friendly Landscaping™ Program Coordinator Susan Griffith, as well as knowledgeable Manatee County Master Gardeners, for slideshow lectures about the latest topics affecting Manatee County. Sign up online through EventBrite (link below), stop by the park, or call 941-761-2866 to reserve your spot.



**Florida-Friendly Landscaping™:
Planting, Establishing & Maintaining Landscape Plants
11am Thursday
June 25, 2026**

Join us for an easygoing session all about planting, establishing, and maintaining your landscape plants. Whether you're a newbie or just want to brush up on your gardening skills, this in-person event will give you practical tips and tricks to teach you how to properly plant, establish and prune to have a garden space that thrives!

[Planting, Establishing & Maintaining Landscape Plants Tickets, Thursday, June 25 • 11 AM - 12:30 PM | Eventbrite](#)



**Poisonous Plants
11am Thursday
July 23, 2026**

Join us for a fun and eye-opening event all about poisonous plants! Discover which plants to watch out for, learn what toxicity really means in the great scheme of things, and learn some cool facts in a relaxed, friendly setting. Perfect for nature lovers and curious minds alike. Don't miss out on this chance to get to know more about nature's sneaky dangers!

[Poisonous Plants 🦴 Tickets, Thursday, July 23 • 11 AM - 12:30 PM | Eventbrite](#)

June 25, 2026 11am Thursday [Planting, Establishing & Maintaining Landscape Plants](#)

Join us to learn how to plant, nurture, and care for your new plants with confidence!

July 23, 2026 11am Thursday [Poisonous Plants](#)

We'll explore everything from the mildly toxic varieties to the 6 highly dangerous plants you need to watch out for!

Aug. 20, 2026 11am Thursday [Heat Tolerant Plants](#)

Discover the toughest, most resilient plants that can thrive in Florida's extreme heat!

Sept. 24, 2026 11am Thursday [Salt Tolerant Plants for Coastal Landscapes](#)

Learn which plants can withstand anything from salty breezes and sandy soils to saltwater inundation.

Oct. 22, 2026 11am Thursday [Backyard Landscaping for Wildlife](#)

Create a haven for birds, bats, butterflies and others in need of a neighborhood sanctuary.

Nov. 19, 2026 11am Thursday [Cold Weather Plant Preparedness](#)

Learn how to effectively prepare your plants to withstand freezing winter temperatures.



HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS!

Need Bright Futures Hours?

9am-Noon Wednesdays June 3rd – August 5, 2026
Palma Sola Botanical Park ~ 9800 17th Ave. NW Bradenton

The non-profit 501(c)(3) Palma Sola Botanical Park is in search of high school volunteers (rising Freshman and up) to come help us with planting, weeding, propagating, mulching, office work, etc. to earn Bright Futures community service hours for college. No experience is needed, we provide & fill out your Bright Futures paperwork, provide snacks & cold water, and make it fun! Our normal after school volunteering 3-6pm on Wednesdays will resume during the schoolyear August 12, 2026-May 26, 2027. Call us at 941-761-2866 with any questions or just show up when you can on Wednesdays! www.palmasolabp.org





SEED LIBRARIES

Meaghan and Susan from Manatee Library joined us recently during our May horticultural class to share the exciting news about the new seed libraries. So far, the Palmetto and Braden River Branch libraries now have seed libraries where you can "check out" seeds. Obviously, you don't need to return them, but they do encourage you to bring in other seeds to share. They also brought a variety of pollinator books and renewed library cards on the spot. To continue the collaboration, they will hold a storytime during our Summer Fun Nature Classes and have a booth at our Fall Plants & More Sale.



KRYSTAL PATTERSON

~ June ~

Krystal has been fantastic helping with community outreach to get the word out about our beautiful gardens. She attended Chamber of Commerce and Discover Bradenton networking events, as well as manning our booth at the Bradenton Public Market. You may have seen her most recently selling 50/50 tickets at our Garden Party. Thank you for jumping in and choosing to volunteer your time with us, we really appreciate it!

"Many hands make light work."

ART IN THE DARK PARK

MADI WILKINSON, our **June** featured Artist of the

Month, is a photographer focusing on wildlife and nature. All of the stunning photographs are for sale & a portion helps support Palma Sola Botanical Park!





Come check out our the gorgeous hand-carved sculptures currently on display in our gardens by Ennye Gallery. If you are an artist and interested in displaying your work, please contact us. For more information, click on the link below.

ARTIST OF THE MONTH INFORMATION





FLORA ~ WHAT'S BLOOMING?

The beautiful images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.





PIC•COLLAGE

FEATHERED FRIENDS ~ RECENTLY SPOTTED!

The beautiful images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.





FAUNA ~ RECENTLY SPOTTED!

The beautiful images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.



Enjoy yoga here at the park in our beautiful, relaxing setting. Plus, a portion of the proceeds support the Park!

MONDAYS 4-5pm with *Angela Simone*
Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels

Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

TUESDAYS 6-7pm with *Laura Bennett* – *She's Back!*
Yoga/Pilates/Weights

Call 941-758-1741 to reserve your spot.

WEDNESDAYS 9-10am with *Angela Simone*
Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels

Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

Please contact the instructors directly with any questions, prices, and to reserve your spot.

Our new Zumba class begins June 1st!



 **MONDAYS**
9:30AM

 **PALMA SOLA BOTANICAL PARK**
Galleria Building
(Indoors & Air Conditioned)
9800 17th Ave NW
Bradenton, FL 34209

DROP-IN	MOST POPULAR!	BEST VALUE!	FIRST CLASS
\$15	5 CLASS PASS \$60	10 CLASS PASS \$100	\$5
Pay as you go	\$12/class Use within 90 days	\$10/class Use within 90 days	New clients only One-time intro offer



Please consider supporting the park by becoming a member or renewing your membership. An annual gift of membership supports the ongoing sustainability and enhancement of the gardens. There are several levels for all budgets that come with enhancement of the gardens. There are several levels for all budgets that come with perks including reciprocal membership to botanical parks across the country. Memberships begin anytime and are valid for 1 year from the start date.



AMERICAN HORTICULTURAL SOCIETY

**RECIPROCAL
GARDEN NETWORK**

member garden

[Reciprocal Admissions Program – American Horticultural Society \(ahsgardening.org\)](http://ahsgardening.org)

Join Here ~ MEMBERSHIP



OUR STORY

In 1990, the grassroots initiative for a botanical park began when local citizens and community groups rallied to save the 10 acre site from development that had previously served as the Manatee County Nursery. In 1993, the non-profit 501(c)(3) Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc. was established and the park has evolved ever since. The park does not charge an entrance fee and receives no federal, state, or local government subsidies. We rely greatly on donations to keep the park open free of charge to the public 7 days per week.

HOURS

Park Hours:

8am~Dusk Every Day

Please note that we close earlier due to the time change!

Office Hours:

8am~5pm Mon.-Fri.

ALWAYS FREE ADMISSION!

STAFF

Beverly Z. Burdette, Executive Director
bev@palmasolabp.org (New email!)

Jennifer Gunter, Office Manager/Venue Rentals

info@palmasolabp.org (New email!)

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

President - Kristin Mead, Retired Boyd Insurance

Vice President - Tyler Pullen, Pullen Investment Management

Treasurer - Michael Jaster, Manatee Rare Fruit Council

Secretary - Aedan Stockdale, Man. Co. Natural Resources

Josh Beyer, Civil Engineer

Barney Hass, Retired Realtor

Jack Hawkins, Retired Attorney

Richard Larsen, Florida Division of Forestry

Richard Larsen, Florida Division of Forestry

John Lowenberg, Retired Fundraiser

Emeritus - Nick Baden, Retired Attorney

Ex-Officio - Beverly Burdette, Florida Landscape Architect

CONTACT INFORMATION

Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc.

Park Address:

9800 17th Avenue Northwest

Bradenton, Florida **34209**

Mailing Address:

P.O. Box 14214

Bradenton, Florida 34280

(941) 761-2866

info@palmasolabp.org

www.palmasolabp.org



Our mission is to serve as a unique community resource dedicated to providing an interactive learning environment that fosters an appreciation of nature and landscaping, preserves our natural resources and promotes environmental education.

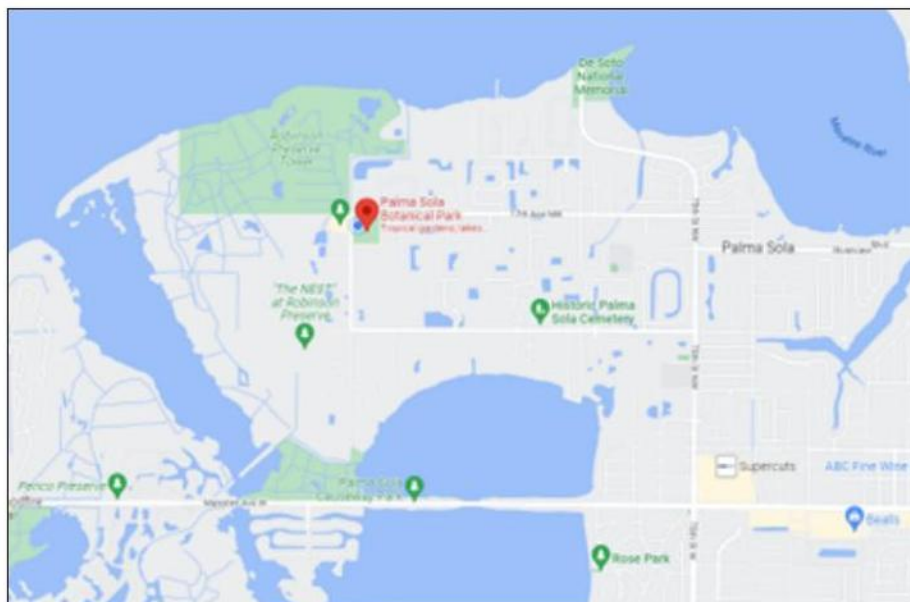
The Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc. is a 501(c)(3) non-profit organization. Contributions are normally tax deductible under current IRS codes.



DONATE HERE

Manatee Rare Fruit Council





Garden Party!

Evening Under the Stars

TO BENEFIT THE PALMA SOLA BOTANICAL PARK!



Event Sponsors

Red Silk Cotton Level

PULLEN
INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT

Sharon & Tommy
Howze

Royal Poinciana Level



Silk Floss Level



Sandra Robinson

Tom Brown & Karla Hager

Barney Hass & Jeanne Cowan

Royal Palm Level

Ed Kennedy & Nancy Reed ~ In Memory of Bob Christopher by Margaret Christopher
Parker Family Dental ~ Gail Hannah ~ Kitty Kole ~ Pat Van Court ~ David & Marion Perez
Becky Tolerton ~ John & Nancy Flynn ~ Publix ~ Breadsmith

Thank you for your continued support to help our garden grow!

